

SOC ANALYST INVESTIGATION REPORT

SOC141 – Phishing URL Detected

Event ID 86 • LetsDefend SOC Simulation

Alert Name	SOC141 – Phishing URL Detected
Event ID	86
Severity	High
Alert Type / Source	Proxy
Event Time	Mar 22, 2021, 09:23 PM
Analysis Verdict	TRUE POSITIVE – Malicious phishing URL accessed
Investigation Time	25 minutes
Playbook Success Rate	100%
Alert Closed	Jul 26, 2026, 09:33 PM

1. Executive Summary

On March 22, 2021 at 09:23 PM, the proxy security control generated a high-severity alert (SOC141 – Phishing URL Detected) after the workstation EmilyComp (172.16.17.49), used by the account "ellie", requested a suspicious external URL hosted on the Russian domain mogagrocol.ru.

The requested URL pointed to a PHP page buried inside a WordPress plugin directory (/wp-content/plugins/akismet/fv/index.php) and carried the victim's own e-mail address as a URL parameter (?email=ellie@letsdefend.io) — a pattern strongly associated with credential-harvesting phishing pages hosted on compromised WordPress websites.

Investigation confirmed that the device action was Allowed, and proxy logs in Log Management contained two matching events between the source and destination, proving the connection was not blocked and the page was actually reached. Reputation analysis on VirusTotal returned 13 / 92 malicious detections with a community score of -4, with vendors including BitDefender, ADMINUSLabs, alphaMountain.ai and Chong Lua Dao classifying the URL as Phishing / Malicious.

Conclusion: The alert was closed as a **TRUE POSITIVE**. The URL is confirmed malicious and was successfully accessed by the endpoint, so the case requires containment of EmilyComp, a credential reset for the user "ellie", and blocking of the domain and IP at the proxy/firewall.

2. Alert Details

The following details were taken directly from the SOC alert record in the LetsDefend Monitoring module.

Event ID	86
Event Time	Mar 22, 2021, 09:23 PM
Rule	SOC141 – Phishing URL Detected
Severity / Level	High / Security Analyst
Source Address	172.16.17.49
Source Hostname	EmilyComp
Source Port	55662
Destination Address	91.189.114.8
Destination Hostname	mogagrocol.ru
Destination Port	80 (HTTP – cleartext)
Username	ellie
Request URL	http://mogagrocol.ru/wp-content/plugins/akismet/fv/index.php?email=ellie@letsdefend.io
User Agent	Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 6.1; Win64; x64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Chrome/79.0.3945.88 Safari/537.36
Device Action	Allowed ← traffic was NOT blocked

SEVERITY	DATE	RULE NAME	EVENTID	TYPE
High	Mar, 22, 2021, 09:23 PM	SOC141 - Phishing URL Detected	86	Proxy
EventID : 86 Event Time : Mar, 22, 2021, 09:23 PM Rule : SOC141 - Phishing URL Detected Level : Security Analyst Source Address : 172.16.17.49 Source Hostname : EmilyComp Destination Address : 91.189.114.8 Destination Hostname : mogagrocol.ru Username : ellie Request URL : http://mogagrocol.ru/wp-content/plugins/akismet/v/index.php?email=ellie@letsdefend.io User Agent : Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 6.1; Win64; x64) AppleWebKit/537.36 (KHTML, like Gecko) Chrome/79.0.3945.88 Safari/537.36 Device Action : Allowed				

Figure 1 – Full alert record for Event ID 86 in the LetsDefend Monitoring module.

3. Investigation Process

The alert was taken ownership of and analysed following the SOC141 phishing playbook. Each step below documents what was checked, the evidence obtained and the conclusion drawn.

3.1 Case Handling Workflow and Safe-Analysis Practice

The case was handled using the standard SOC alert lifecycle before any technical analysis began:

- **Take ownership** of the alert so the queue reflects who is working it and duplicate effort is avoided.
- **Create the case** and start the associated SOC141 playbook, so every investigative decision is recorded against the event.
- **Collect the alert data points** (event time, source/destination address, username, request URL, user agent, device action) before pivoting to any external tool.
- **Answer each playbook question with evidence**, add artifacts, write the analyst note, then close the case with a verdict.

Safe-analysis note: suspicious URLs are never opened from a production workstation. Any manual browsing of the phishing page is performed inside an isolated analysis VM or an online sandbox, and the URL is defanged (hxxp://mogagrocol[.]ru/...) whenever it is written into tickets, e-mails or reports so it cannot be clicked accidentally.

3.2 Step 1 – Initial Triage of the Request URL

Before touching any tooling, the URL itself was examined for phishing indicators:

- **Suspicious TLD and unknown domain:** mogagrocol.ru is a Russian domain with no business relationship to the organisation.
- **Plugin directory abuse:** the path /wp-content/plugins/akismet/fv/index.php places a PHP page inside a legitimate WordPress plugin folder — a classic sign that a vulnerable WordPress site has been compromised and repurposed to host a phishing kit.
- **Pre-filled victim e-mail:** the parameter ?email=ellie@letsdefend.io shows the link was personally crafted for the recipient, so the fake login page can pre-populate her address and appear legitimate. This is a hallmark of targeted credential harvesting.
- **Cleartext HTTP on port 80:** no TLS, so any credentials submitted would travel unencrypted.
- **Device Action = Allowed:** the proxy permitted the request, meaning this could not be dismissed as a blocked attempt.

3.3 Step 2 – Identifying the Affected Endpoint

The source address was resolved in the Endpoint Security module to identify the owner and criticality of the machine involved.

Hostname	EmilyComp
IP Address	172.16.17.49
Domain	LetsDefend
Operating System	Windows 10 (64-bit)
Client / Server	Client workstation
Primary User	Emily
Last Login	Dec 05, 2020, 04:12 PM

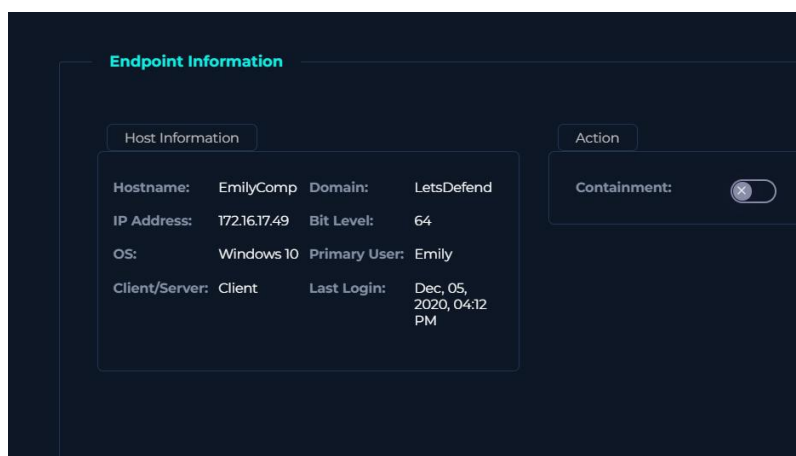


Figure 2 – Endpoint information for the source host EmilyComp (172.16.17.49).

The host is a standard Windows 10 client workstation rather than a server, which limits blast radius but still exposes the user's domain credentials and mailbox. No malicious process, suspicious command line or outbound C2 beacon was observed on the endpoint beyond the browser request itself.

3.4 Step 3 – Playbook: "Has Anyone Accessed the IP/URL/Domain?"

The playbook directs the analyst to Log Management to determine whether the connection actually completed, rather than relying on the alert alone.

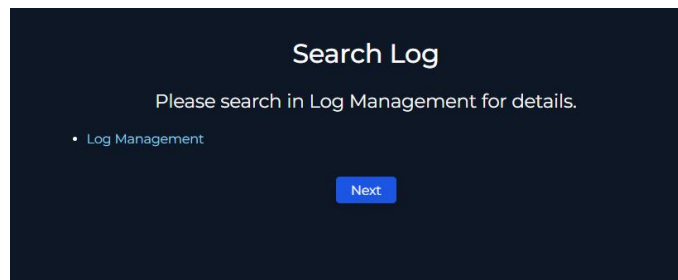


Figure 3 – Playbook step directing the analyst to search Log Management.

A search was run pairing the two endpoints of the session:

| Source Address equals "172.16.17.49" and Destination Address equals "91.189.114.8"

The query returned 2 events, confirming the workstation successfully communicated with the malicious host. The raw firewall log records source_port 55662 and destination_port 80, matching the proxy alert exactly and corroborating the request URL.

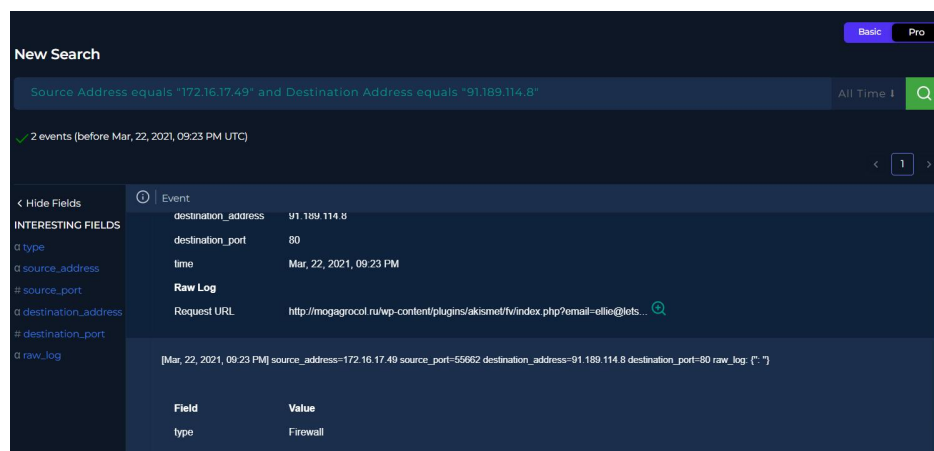


Figure 4 – Log Management confirms two events between 172.16.17.49 and 91.189.114.8.

Playbook answer: Accessed — the traffic was allowed and the phishing page was reached by the user.

3.5 Step 4 – Playbook: "Analyze URL Address"

The full request URL was submitted to VirusTotal for reputation analysis and cross-checked against additional URL scanning services.

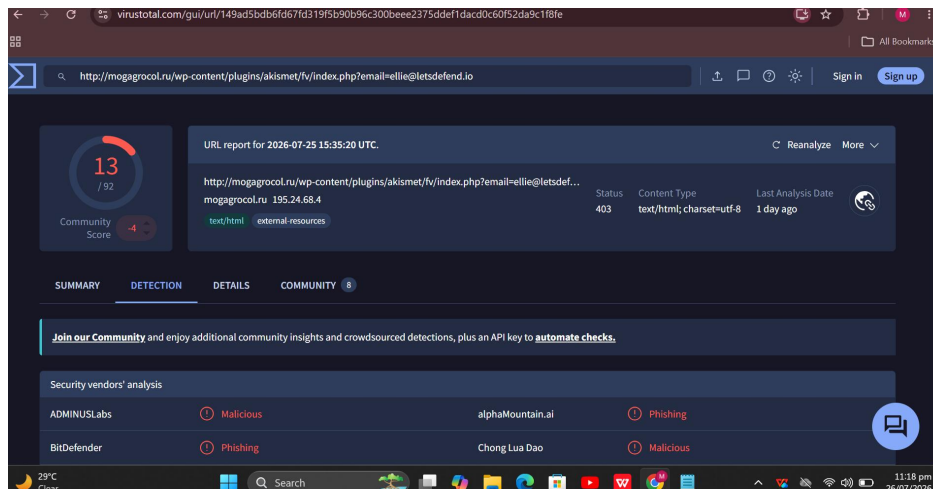


Figure 5 – VirusTotal URL report: 13/92 security vendors flag the URL as malicious/phishing.

Indicator	Result
Detection ratio	13 / 92 security vendors flagged the URL
Community score	-4 (negative reputation)
Vendor verdicts	ADMINUSLabs – Malicious; alphaMountain.ai – Phishing; BitDefender – Phishing; Chong Lua Dao – Malicious
Resolved IP (VT)	195.24.68.4 (mogagrocol.ru)
HTTP status at scan	403 Forbidden – content type text/html; charset=utf-8
Categories	text/html, external-resources

The 403 response returned during the later scan simply indicates the phishing page is no longer publicly served (typically taken down or restricted after abuse reporting); it does not reduce the severity of the original access, which occurred while the page was live.

Playbook answer: Malicious — the URL is confirmed as a phishing/credential-harvesting page by multiple independent vendors.

3.6 Step 5 – Extended OSINT Corroboration

Beyond the mandatory playbook questions, the indicator was enriched using open-source tooling. This is the step that separates a checklist answer from an investigation, because a single vendor score should never be the only basis for a verdict.

Tool / Source	What it is used for	Outcome for this case
VirusTotal	Multi-engine URL/domain reputation, resolutions, community score.	13/92 malicious, community score - 4, resolves to 195.24.68.4.
Secondary URL scanner (URLhaus / urlscan.io)	Independent confirmation and a rendered view of the page without	Corroborated the phishing classification.

	visiting it directly.	
Hybrid Analysis	Sandbox detonation; "contacted hosts" history to see what the domain talks to.	Used as supporting context only — sandbox behaviour does not describe what our endpoint did.
Maltego / WHOIS	Domain footprinting: registrant data, related IPs, outgoing links, associated addresses.	Mapped infrastructure around mogagrocol.ru for artifact submission.

Manual inspection of the page (from an isolated VM) showed a WordPress-hosted page that no longer served the phishing content, consistent with the 403 response seen on VirusTotal. All resulting indicators — the URL, the domain and the associated IP addresses — were submitted as case artifacts before closure.

4. Findings and Analysis

#	Finding	Evidence
1	A user workstation requested a known phishing URL hosted on a compromised WordPress site.	Proxy alert + VirusTotal 13/92 detections
2	The request was ALLOWED by the proxy — no preventive control blocked it.	Device Action: Allowed
3	The connection completed; the page was actually reached by the endpoint.	2 matching events in Log Management
4	The link was personalised with the victim's e-mail address, indicating a targeted phishing e-mail rather than opportunistic browsing.	URL parameter ?email=ellie@letsdefend.io
5	Traffic used cleartext HTTP (port 80), so any submitted credentials would be unencrypted.	destination_port = 80 in raw log
6	No malware download or secondary payload was observed following the request.	Endpoint and log review

Because the page was reached but no file execution followed, the most probable impact is credential exposure — the user may have submitted her mailbox password to the fake login form. This is treated as a confirmed security incident until a credential reset and mailbox review rule it out.

4.1 MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Tactic	Technique	Relevance to this alert
Initial Access	T1566.002 – Phishing: Spearphishing Link	Personalised link delivered to the user leading to a fake login page.
Execution	T1204.001 – User Execution: Malicious Link	The user clicked the link; proxy logs confirm the page was requested.
Credential Access	T1056.003 – Input Capture: Web Portal Capture	Phishing page designed to capture credentials typed into a spoofed form.
Reconnaissance	T1598.003 – Phishing for Information: Spearphishing Link	E-mail address embedded in the URL confirms prior targeting of the victim.

4.2 Analyst Reasoning: The "Has Anyone Accessed It?" Trap

This question is the most commonly mis-answered part of the SOC141 case, and it is worth documenting the reasoning explicitly. At least one published community walkthrough of this alert reaches the opposite conclusion and answers "Not accessed", after leaning on the contacted-hosts history from a sandbox report.

That reasoning does not hold, for a simple reason: a sandbox report describes what the sample or URL did inside someone else's detonation environment. It says nothing about whether our endpoint reached the page. Only our own telemetry can answer that.

The evidence from internal telemetry is unambiguous:

- **Device Action = Allowed** — the proxy did not block the request.

- **Two matching events in Log Management** for the exact source/destination pair, with source port 55662 to destination port 80.
- **The alert itself is proxy-sourced**, meaning it was generated from observed traffic rather than from an e-mail gateway inspecting an unclicked link.

Therefore the correct answer is **Accessed**, which is the answer submitted in this investigation. The practical rule: answer questions about your environment from your environment's logs, and use external intelligence only to characterise the indicator, never to decide whether your user touched it.

5. Playbook Completion and Verdict

Both playbook questions were answered on the basis of the evidence collected, and the case was documented with an analyst note before closing.

Has Anyone Accessed IP/URL/Domain?	Accessed ✓
Analyze URL Address	Malicious ✓
Extracted Artifact	<code>http://mogagrocol.ru/wp-content/plugins/akismet/fv/index.php?email=ellie@letsdefend.io</code> – Phishing URL detected

The screenshot shows a dark-themed interface with three main sections. The first section, 'Playbook Answers', contains two entries: 'Has Anyone Accessed IP/URL/Domain?' with a green checkmark and 'Analyze URL Address' with a green checkmark. The second section, 'Playbook Note', contains a text entry: 'Phishing URL was detected and event was happen on Mar, 22, 2021, 09:23 PM and also the last log in for the source address whose hostname is EmilyComp was Dec, 05, 2020, 04:12 PM. The URL which was send is also malicious as I scan it on virus total and other url scanning tool like url haunts.' The third section, 'Extracted Artifacts', contains a table with three columns: Value, Comment, and Type. The table has one row with the value 'http://mogagrocol.ru/wp-content/plugins/akismet/fv/index.php?email=ellie@letsdefend.io', comment 'Phishing URL detected', and type 'E-mail Domain'.

Value	Comment	Type
<code>http://mogagrocol.ru/wp-content/plugins/akismet/fv/index.php?email=ellie@letsdefend.io</code>	Phishing URL detected	E-mail Domain

Figure 6 – Playbook answers, analyst note and extracted artifacts.

The alert was then closed as a True Positive with the note "Malicious URL DETECTED".

The screenshot shows a dark-themed dialog box titled 'Close Alert'. It contains a text input field for 'Event ID' with the value '86'. Below this is a radio button selection for 'True Positive' (selected) and 'False Positive'. Below that is a text input field for 'Note' with the value 'Malicious URL DETECTED'. At the bottom is a blue button labeled 'Close Alert'.

Figure 7 – Closing the alert as a True Positive.

SEVERITY	DATE CLOSED	RULE NAME	EVENTID	TYPE	RESULT	ACTION
High	Jul, 26, 2026, 09:33 PM	SOC141 - Phishing URL Detected	86	Proxy	✓	↺

EventID :	86
Event Time :	Mar, 22, 2021, 09:23 PM
Rule :	SOC141 - Phishing URL Detected
Answer :	True Positive (+5 Point)
Playbook Answers :	Has Anyone Accessed IP/URL/Domain? (+5 Point) Analyze URL Address (+5 Point)
Analyst Note :	Malicious URL DETECTED
Community Walkthrough :	Show
Rate this case :	☆
Writeups :	✍
Discussion :	💬
Share :	📧 🐦 📘

Figure 8 – Closed alert record showing the True Positive verdict and both playbook answers scored.

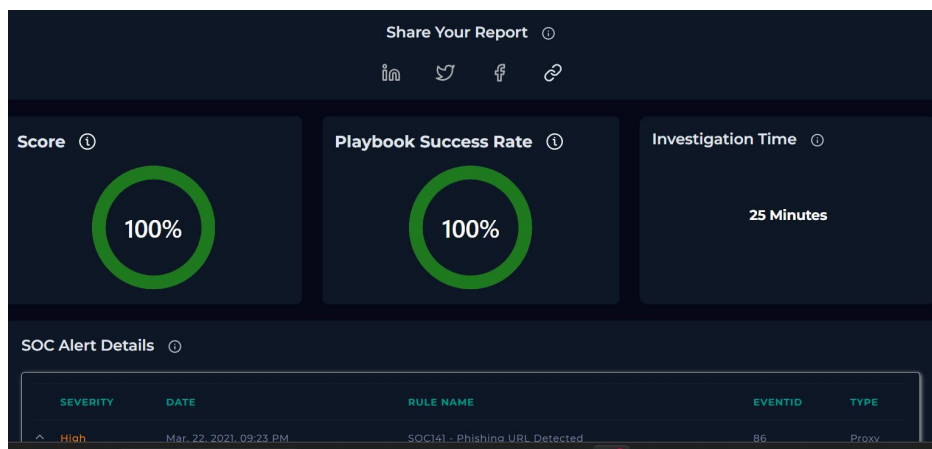


Figure 9 – Case summary: 100% score, 100% playbook success rate, 25-minute investigation time.

Final result: 100% score, 100% playbook success rate, closed within 25 minutes of investigation time.

6. Containment and Response Recommendations

Because the malicious URL was reached rather than blocked, the following actions are recommended. Containment on the endpoint was still toggled off at the time of the alert review, so isolation is the first priority.

Immediate (0–1 hour)

- Isolate / contain the host EmilyComp (172.16.17.49) from the network until the review is complete.
- Force a password reset for the user "ellie" and invalidate all active sessions and tokens.
- Enforce or verify MFA on the affected account to blunt any credential that was already harvested.
- Block the domain mogagrocol.ru and the IPs 91.189.114.8 and 195.24.68.4 at the proxy, firewall and DNS layer.

Short term (same day)

- Review mailbox activity for "ellie" — new inbox rules, forwarding rules, and sign-ins from unusual IPs or geographies.
- Search proxy logs organisation-wide for any other host that contacted mogagrocol.ru, to identify additional recipients of the same phishing campaign.

- Retrieve the original phishing e-mail from the mail gateway, extract sender, subject and headers, and purge it from all mailboxes.
- Run a full anti-malware scan on EmilyComp and review browser downloads around 09:23 PM on Mar 22, 2021.

Longer term / preventive

- Add the URL and domain to the threat-intelligence blocklist and create a detection rule for URLs containing an internal e-mail address as a parameter.
- Restrict or inspect cleartext HTTP traffic to newly seen and low-reputation external domains.
- Deliver targeted phishing-awareness refresher training to the affected user and her department.

7. Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)

Type	Indicator
URL	http://mogagrocol.ru/wp-content/plugins/akismet/fv/index.php?email=ellie@letsdefend.io
Domain	mogagrocol.ru
IP (destination)	91.189.114.8 : 80
IP (VT resolution)	195.24.68.4
Affected host	EmilyComp - 172.16.17.49 (Windows 10 x64, domain LetsDefend)
Affected user	ellie / ellie@letsdefend.io
User agent	Mozilla/5.0 (Windows NT 6.1; Win64; x64) ... Chrome/79.0.3945.88 Safari/537.36

8. Skills Demonstrated

- Alert triage and ownership of a high-severity proxy alert in a SOC monitoring queue.
- Structured playbook execution and evidence-based answering of each investigative question.
- Log analysis using field-based queries in a SIEM/Log Management interface to confirm whether traffic completed.
- URL and domain reputation analysis with VirusTotal and secondary scanning services, including interpretation of detection ratios and community scoring.
- Recognition of phishing tradecraft: compromised WordPress hosting, plugin-directory abuse and e-mail parameters used to personalise credential-harvesting pages.
- Endpoint context gathering and impact assessment against the affected user and asset.
- Incident documentation, MITRE ATT&CK mapping, IOC extraction and clear closure of the case as a True Positive.

9. References

- LetsDefend Monitoring – Event ID 86, SOC141 – Phishing URL Detected:
https://app.letsdefend.io/monitoring?channel=closed&event_id=86
- VirusTotal URL report for the analysed indicator (13/92 detections, community score -4).
- N. Varghese, "Let's Defend: SOC141 – Phishing URL Detected" (Medium, Feb 2022) – consulted as a community walkthrough; referenced in Section 4.2 where its conclusion on the access question differs from the conclusion drawn here.
- MITRE ATT&CK Enterprise Matrix – T1566.002, T1204.001, T1056.003, T1598.003.

Report produced from the LetsDefend SOC simulation platform, Event ID 86 (SOC141 – Phishing URL Detected). All figures are screenshots captured during the live investigation.